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YouTube Shorts is adding
an image-to-video AI
tool, new AI effects

YouTube [announced](#) on Wednesday that it's giving Shorts creators access to new generative AI features, including an image-to-video AI tool and new AI effects.

The image to video feature lets users turn a picture from their camera roll into a six-second video. Users will see a selection of suggestions that are relevant to the photo they uploaded. YouTube says the feature can be used to add movement to landscape photos, animate pictures of everyday photos, or bring group photos to life.

In an example given by YouTube, the feature turns a static image of a pedestrian signal into a short video that slowly zooms into a dancing version of the walking man symbol.

IMAGE CREDITS:

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IMAGE CREDITS: YOUTUBE

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The feature works similarly to an [offering already available](#) in Gemini. Plus, it's similar to the Animate tool in [Meta's Edits app](#), which also uses AI to transform static images into videos.

The new tool is rolling out over the next week in the United States, Canada, Australia, and New Zealand. YouTube plans to bring it to more regions later this year. It's worth noting that Google Photos is also getting a similar image-to-video tool.

As for the new AI effects, creators can use them to transform their doodles into artistic images and turn their selfies into videos where they're swimming underwater, twinning with someone, and more. Users can find these new effects by navigating to the "Effects" icon in the Shorts

camera and then tapping “AI” to browse all of the generative effects.



IMAGE CREDITS: YOUTUBE

YouTube notes that the features announced today are powered by Veo 2, Google’s AI model for video generation. YouTube says it uses [SynthID](#) watermarks and [clear labels](#) to indicate that these creations were generated with AI.

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Last month at Cannes Lions 2025, YouTube CEO Neal Mohan announced that [Google's Veo 3 video generator](#), which can generate both video and audio, will be coming to Shorts later this summer. He also shared that Shorts are now averaging more than [200 billion daily views](#).

YouTube also announced on Wednesday that AI Playground is its new home for generative AI creation tools, inspirational examples, prefilled prompts, and more. Creators can find AI Playground by tapping the Create button and then the sparkle icon in the top right corner. It's available now for everyone in the United States, Canada, Australia, and New Zealand.

Topics: [AI](#) [Apps](#) [YouTube](#) [YouTube Shorts](#)



Aisha Malik

Consumer News Reporter |

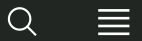
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Aisha Malik — 12:59 PM PST · November 21, 2024

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YouTube [announced](#) on Thursday that its [Dream Screen](#) feature for Shorts now lets you create AI-generated video backgrounds. Up until now, Dream Screen could only create image backgrounds. The new capability is possible due to the integration of [Google DeepMind's AI video-generation model, Veo](#), which can create 1080p video clips in various cinematic styles.

Users can now use the feature to turn text prompts into AI video backgrounds. To access the feature, you need to go into the Shorts camera, tap the “green screen” icon, and then select “Dream Screen.” From there, you can type in a prompt, such

as “candy landscape” or “magical forest with a stream.” Next, you can pick an animation style and then tap “Create.”

The Dream Screen tool will then generate a series of video backgrounds that you can choose from. Once you select an AI video background, you can record a video with it behind you.

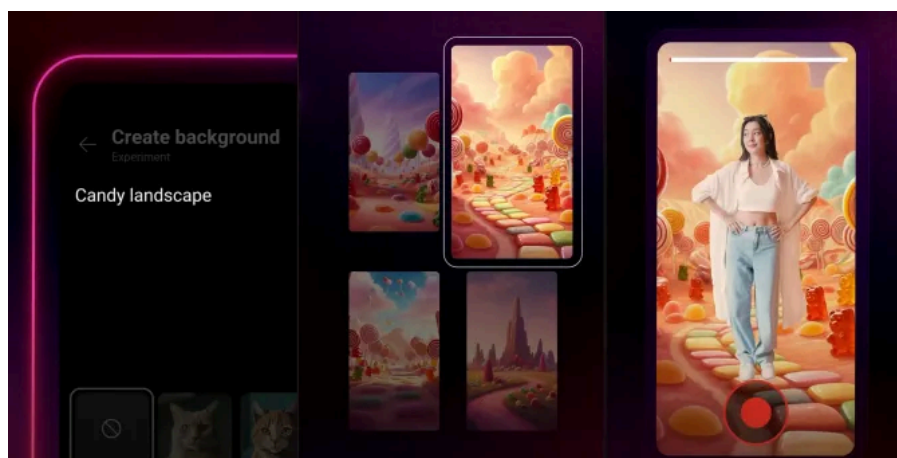


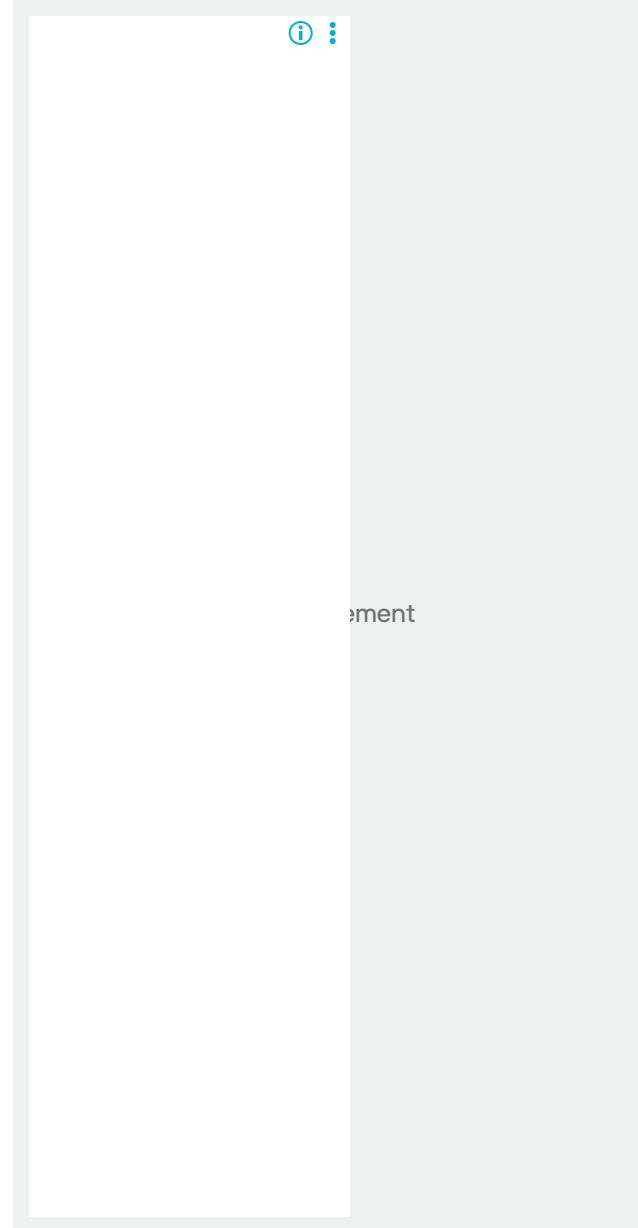
IMAGE CREDITS: YOUTUBE

YouTube says the new feature can be used for things like putting yourself in the setting of your favorite book or creating an animated opening for your Short.

In the future, YouTube plans to give creators the ability to generate six-second-long stand-alone video clips for Shorts through Dream Screen.

It’s worth noting that YouTube is giving Shorts creators access to a feature that’s not available on TikTok, the leading short-form video platform. While TikTok lets [creators generate AI-powered background images](#), the company currently doesn’t let you create video backgrounds.

The new feature is now available in the United States, Canada, Australia, and New Zealand.



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YouTube Shorts takes on TikTok with new creation tools

Aisha Malik — 9:00 AM PDT · April 3, 2025

As YouTube Shorts continues to compete with TikTok, the platform is announcing new upcoming features to help creators publish engaging short-form videos.

Creators will get access to an improved video editor, the ability to generate AI stickers, a feature that syncs content to the beat of a song, enhanced templates, and more.

The launch of the new tools comes just days before the [April 5 TikTok ban deadline](#). Given the timing of the announcement, YouTube is likely looking to court creators to its platform and capitalize on the

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potential void left by TikTok if it faces a ban in the United States.

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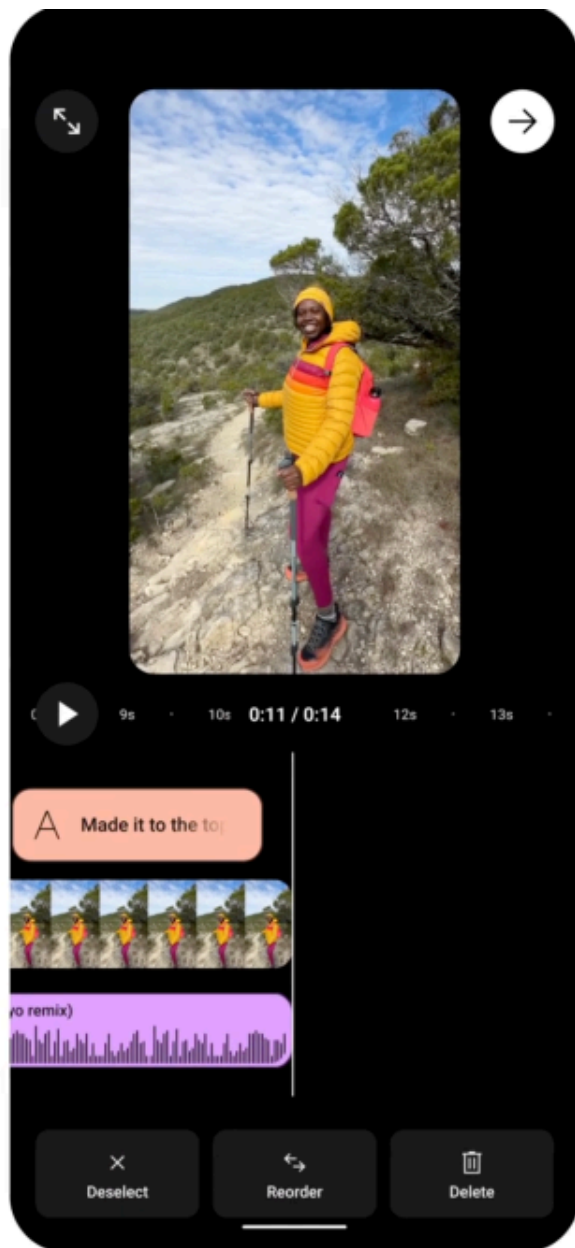


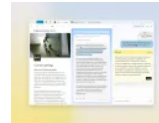
IMAGE CREDITS: YOUTUBE

YouTube says the new and improved video editor will allow users to easily adjust the timing of each clip, move or remove clips to create a rough version, add music or timed text, and preview their Short to make sure it tells the story the way they want it to. YouTube plans to roll out additional editing updates in the future.

The company notes that an improved video editor has been a top request from Shorts creators.

TikTok is known for having robust editing tools, so it makes sense for YouTube to give its creators access to more of the same tools. Plus, the launch

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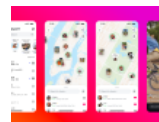
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of the improved video editor is significant, as Meta is said to be weeks away from releasing an [“Edits” app](#) that purportedly rivals ByteDance’s CapCut.

IMAGE CREDITS: YOUTUBE

As for the new AI Stickers, creators will be able to generate custom stickers using a simple text prompt. In an example shared by YouTube, a user can generate an AI sticker of “a strong plant with muscles.”

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YouTube Shorts will also roll out the ability for creators to add image stickers to their videos. For example, creators will be able to share different options for outfit inspiration by uploading photos from their camera roll and turning them into image stickers.

In addition, creators will soon be able to pick a song and have their clips automatically aligned with the music’s rhythm. Before this, creators would have had to manually sync clips to songs.

The feature appears to be similar to CapCut’s “Beats” tool, which automatically syncs music to clips.

YouTube is also going to improve templates, as users will be able to pull photos from their gallery and use them in templates. The company also plans to add effects within templates. Given the popularity of effects on TikTok, it makes sense for YouTube Shorts to explore them as well, especially since they can sometimes create trends.

The new features are expected to roll out in the coming months.

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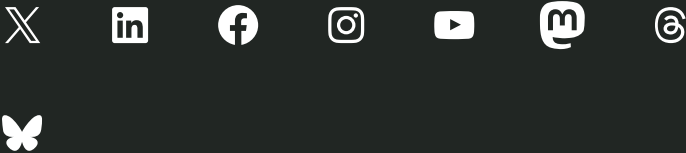
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